Nano and Small Commercial Vehicle segment. This caused a huge NPA loss in both Tata Motors and Tata Motor Finance, to the tune of nearly Rs 4000 crore.'

After dismal sales in June 2018, Tata Motors acknowledged, 'We are well aware that the Nano in its present form cannot continue beyond 2019 and may need fresh investments to survive.' Along with that, Tata Motors pulled out the car from Nepal, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh. Later, commenting on the decline in sales, R.C. Bhargava, chairman of Maruti Suzuki India, stated how the Nano had failed to meet the people's aspirations. 'People are looking for something beyond just transport. I think the Nano failed to meet the aspirations of the car buyer in its totality, maybe not in terms of one or two facets, but in its totality,' he said.

Many in Tata Motors feel that if Ratan had continued as chairman, the Nano project would not have died. Sumantran says, 'If the Nano would have been continued, it could have become a successful car.' Wagh echoes this and says that if Ratan would have continued at the helm, with his 'determination' and 'never-say-die' attitude, 'he would have made it [the Nano] a success'.

Nano: The Technology Demonstrator

The Nano and its importance in Ratan's life story would be incomplete without a discussion on how Ratan broke new boundaries of innovation in the automobile sector while implementing his dream of producing the world's cheapest car.

Many may term the Nano as Ratan's folly. Others may differ and describe it as a journey that put the spotlight on the Indian automobile industry across the world like never before. In reality, the project proved to the world that India could accomplish what the automobile pundits had dismissed as simply undoable and the utopian dream of a car buff.

The car might not have been a commercial success for a host of reasons, but it was a technology demonstrator par excellence. In many ways, it triggered an automobile revolution. 'Indeed, the Nano is arguably the most significant new car launch in a quarter of a century,' commented *The Independent* in 2008. It benefited not only the Indian consumer but millions around the world. It was a case of Indian innovation showing the way to the